

TorqFall — Level Directory v1

2026-09-04. The round library for [[2 - TorqFall (rulebook)]], built for the **standalone-event frame** (we own the floor all day → we CAN reconfigure between rounds → true Fall-Guys round variety). Goal: a deep bank of rounds we **shuffle** so no two events — and no two heats within an event — feel the same. Renders come later; this is the mechanics + theming spec.

How the directory works

- **3 difficulty tiers × 7+ rounds each = 21+ rounds.** Shuffle within a tier for variety; escalate across tiers for the tournament arc.
- **A "round" = one obstacle recipe on the gauntlet lane.** All are built from the **same modular obstacle kit** (noodle gates, EVA blocks, pendulum, sweeper, ramps, spinners, gates) rearranged — so reconfiguring between rounds is a **layout change, not a rebuild** (2–5 min by crew, allowed because it's a dedicated event).
- **Themes are a skin, not a mechanic.** Any round can wear any map theme (below). Renders/props get made per theme later; mechanics stay constant so we can theme cheaply.
- **Programming a day:** pick a shuffle of Tier-1 rounds for open qualifying → Tier-2 for the bracket → a Tier-3 round for the final. Rotate the shuffle each event so the reel never repeats.
- **Design law (inherited):** every obstacle soft, self-righting / spring-back, no traps, no flip-launch, resets <3s within a round. Speed-limited cars only.

Difficulty knobs (what makes a round harder)

1. **Pinch severity** — how narrow the funnel/gates (tighter = more pile-ups).
 2. **Active vs passive obstacles** — passive (static blocks) → marshal-driven (pendulum, sweeper) → motorised/continuous (spinner, rolling barrels).
 3. **Precision demand** — wide bash lane (easy) → a balance-beam / narrow bridge / gap-hop (hard).
 4. **Elimination pressure** — race-to-finish (soft) → survival/last-standing (hard).
 5. **Round length & obstacle count** — 1 obstacle sudden-death (easy/fast) → a 5-station gauntlet (hard/long).
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TIER 1 — QUALIFIER ROUNDS (beginner, high-chaos, low-skill, race mode)

Purpose: everyone can do it, chaos hides mistakes, fast throughput. Used for non-elim qualifying.

1. **Funnel Dash** — wide start → single narrowing gate → straight sprint to finish. The classic first-pile-up. Pure chaos, zero precision.

2. **Noodle Weave** — 3 staggered pool-noodle gates to slalom; knocked noodles spring back. Introduces steering under pressure.
3. **Block Field** — a field of low EVA foam blocks to bump over/around. Bumpy, forgiving, comic.
4. **The Sweeper (single)** — one marshal-swung foam sweeper bar across an open lane; time your dash. Signature wipe-out, one obstacle = fast.
5. **Bumper Alley** — soft-walled narrow corridor; cars ricochet off foam walls the whole way. Contact is constant and harmless.
6. **Roller Rush** — loose foam balls/barrels rolled down-lane by marshals; drive through the clutter. Cheap, chaotic, very visual.
7. **Ramp Scramble** — a wide low foam ramp up-and-over into the finish. Everyone can climb it; jams at the crest = content.
8. *(spare)* **Balloon Gauntlet** — hanging balloons on strings the cars burst through; pop = crowd noise. (Doubles as a theme cross-over.)

TIER 2 — BRACKET ROUNDS (intermediate, mixed active obstacles, race or survival)

Purpose: the tournament middle — obstacles that actually sort drivers, still forgiving.

1. **Pendulum Pass** — a swinging foam cylinder over a pinch gate; mistime it and you're swatted back. First "read the obstacle" round.
2. **Twin Sweepers** — two offset sweeper bars, marshal-worked opposite phase; thread both. Doubles the wipe-out chance.
3. **The Chicane** — tight S-bend of foam barriers demanding real steering; pack bunches and shuffles order.
4. **Spinner Gate** — a motorised rotating foam cross (low RPM) at a gate; dart through a gap. First continuous/motorised obstacle.
5. **Whack Tunnel** — a covered stretch with foam paddles that marshals push in from the sides. Blind-ish, jumpy, great overhead cam.
6. **Barrel Roll** — a slow rolling foam barrel (on a rope, marshal-fed) moving toward the pack; dodge or get shoved. Menacing on camera.
7. **Rising Gates** — 3 lift-gates a marshal drops/raises on a rhythm; caught under one = held. Adds timing + suspense.
8. *(spare)* **Bridge Squeeze** — a low wide "bridge" (a raised turf platform, no real drop) that narrows to one-car width. Precision pinch.

TIER 3 — FINAL / SURVIVAL ROUNDS (hard, elimination, showpiece — the day's climax)

Purpose: the money rounds. Survival/last-standing, all obstacles live, made for the crowd + the final reel.

1. **The Full Gauntlet** — every station live back-to-back (funnel→noodle→blocks→pendulum→sweeper→finish). The signature run; survival mode.
2. **Hex-a-Fall (last car standing)** — an open pen with marshals working 3 sweepers + rollers; no finish line, **last car still moving wins**. The purest Fall-Guys finale.
3. **The Grinder** — twin spinners + a sweeper in a short pen; chaos density maxed, 60–90s, last-standing.

4. **Tightrope Finish** — a narrow raised turf beam to the finish (fall off = a soft 2cm step down back into the pen, re-enter to retry, but you lose time). Precision under a clock; separates a champion.
 5. **King of the Hill** — a central raised turf mound; hold the top / be first to plant on it while sweepers knock you off. Positional, dramatic, great photo.
 6. **Collapse Gate (the smash finish)** — a **breakable pin-wall / weak-tab wall every survivor must punch through to finish**. Delivers the smash payoff to every player AND **field-tests the TorqSiege collapse mechanic live** (the D1-as-R&D-for-D2 move). Highest-value single round we have.
 7. **Sudden-Death Sweeper** — pack of 8, one giant sweeper, last car moving. 30–45s tiebreaker / filler when the queue is short.
 8. (*spare*) **The Reverse** — run the full gauntlet **backwards** (finish→start); familiar obstacles, inverted flow, resets the crowd's read. Free variety from existing build.
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Map / theme skins (cosmetic layer — renders later)

Any round can wear any theme; a theme = prop dressing + LED colour + a name. Starter set:

- **Neon Circuit** (default TorqWars house — orange/magenta, grid, arcade).
- **Lava Run** (red/black, "floor is lava" foam, volcano props).
- **Ice Fields** (white/cyan, "slippery" look, low-traction *look* only — not actual).
- **Jungle Ruins** (green, vines = noodle gates, temple-collapse = the smash finish).
- **Toy Box** (primary colours, oversized blocks, kid-coded).
- **Cyber Siege** (industrial, ties visually into TorqSiege for cross-event branding).

Rule: build the mechanics kit once; themes are swappable dressing so we get infinite visual variety (and infinite reels) from ~21 mechanical rounds without rebuilding physics.

Next: (a) ~~map each round to the exact kit pieces it needs~~ **done 2026-09-06** — the per-round kit bill of materials + coverage check lives in [[TorqFall — What The Event Needs]] §3 (not Build & Fabrication Plan v1); (b) render 2–3 hero rounds per theme when we're ready to make content; (c) ~~fold the non-elim qualifying + Collapse-Gate finish into [[2 - TorqFall (rulebook)]]~~ **done 2026-09-06** — rulebook §2 now carries the qualifying → bracket → Collapse-Gate-final structure. Pairs with [[Event Ops Standards (all games)]] and [[Car Fleet, Scale & Protection]].
